MIL-B-36558A
14 September 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-36558
8 August 1968

# MILITARY SPECIFICATION

## BED, ADJUSTABLE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a lightweight, folding, adjustable hospital bed for use by medical personnel in field or fixed installations.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

| | |
|---|---|
| TT-E-529 | - Enamel, Alkyd, Semi-gloss. |
| TT-P-1757 | - Primer Coating, Zinc Chromate, Low Moisture Sensitivity. |
| CCC-D-950 | - Dyeing and After Treating Processes for Cotton Cloths. |
| PPP-B-636 | - Boxes, Shipping Fiberboard. |
| PPP-T-60 | - Tape: Packaging, Waterproof. |

MILITARY

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-C-5541 | - Chemical Conversion Coatings on Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys. |
| MIL-M-7298 | - Manual, Technical, Commercial Equipment. |

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6530

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-TEST METHOD-STD-NO. 151 - Metals: Test Methods.
FED-STD-595 - Colors.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER (DPSC)

25024 - Bed, Folding, Hospital, Field.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Material. Except as hereinafter specified, materials shall conform to the applicable portions of the specifications, standards, and drawing listed herein. Materials shall be subjected to the tests and meet the requirements specified in these documents. The metals shall conform to the chemical and physical requirements of the applicable specifications. Materials, not specifically designated herein, but used in the fabrication of the bed, shall be suitable for the purpose intended.

3.3 Design and construction. The design and construction of the folding, adjustable, hospital bed shall be in conformance with DPSC Drawing No. 25024. All of the components listed below shall fit into their intended locations. All adjustments shall function smoothly throughout their design ranges. All components shall fit into the configuration of the folded bed for storage and shipment. When the bed is fully erected, the outer frame shall be 82 $\pm$ 1 inches long by 30 $\pm$ 1/2 inches wide, and the top of the outer frame shall be 28 $\pm$ 1/2 inches high. Tolerances indicated on DPSC Drawing No. 25024 shall not be cumulative so as to exceed the tolerances listed above in overall dimensions. The bed shall consist of the components listed in 3.3.1 through 3.3.7 (also see 6.5).



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3.3.1 Inner and outer frame. The frame shall be complete with cables, legs, locking assemblies, and elevating arcs.

3.3.2 Bed frame cover. The bed frame cover shall be in conformance with MIL-C-37827.

3.3.3 Mattress pad. The mattress pad shall be in conformance with MIL-P-37735.

3.3.4 Mattress pad cover. The mattress pad cover shall be in conformance with MIL-C-37734.

3.3.5 Personal effects bag. The personal effects bag shall be in conformance with MIL-B-37829.

3.3.6 Bed service stand. The bed service stand shall be in conformance with MIL-S-37826.

3.3.7 Insect-bar rods. The two insect-bar rods shall be in conformance with MIL-R-37828.

3.4 Performance.

3.4.1 Assembly. When assembled and tested as specified in 4.5.2, the bed shall have the correct configuration, all accessories shall fit properly in all intended locations, and all adjustments shall function as specified.

3.4.2 End elevation. Maximum elevation angle, for each end of the elevating frame, shall be $65^{\circ} \pm 5^{\circ}$. The elevating frame shall not slip when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.4.3 Strength of elevating frame. The bed shall exhibit no permanent set, slippage, or other failure when tested as specified in 4.5.4.1.

3.4.4 Load bearing capacity. There shall be no failure of any component part of the bed frame when tested as specified in 4.5.4.2.

3.4.5 Stability. The plumb bob shall not oscillate outside the 3-inch circle when the bed is tested as specified in 4.5.5.

3.4.6 Elevating-frame locking cam. The locking cam shall release the elevating frame when a pressure of not less then 20 pounds, nor more than 35 pounds, is applied, when tested as specified in 4.5.6.



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3.5 Finish.

3.5.1 Painted metal surfaces. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned and chemically degreased prior to chemical treatment. All aluminum parts shall be finished with a chemical film conforming to MIL-C-5541. After degreasing and chemical treatment a zinc-chromate primer conforming to TT-P-1757 shall be applied to all metal parts. The primer coat shall form a grounding bond and base for the finishing enamel. The primer coat shall be followed by two baked-on spray coats of synthetic, semi-gloss, enamel in accordance with TT-E-529. Color shall be olive drab, No. 24087 of FED-STD-595. The resultant finish shall be hard, smooth, and highly resistant to abrasion, chipping, and cracking. When tested as specified in 4.5.7, enamel shall not peel off to expose any of the following:

1. Any area exceeding 1/8 inch average diameter.
2. More than one area exceeding 1/16 inch average diameter.
3. More than five areas of any size.

3.5.2 Cotton duck. The finished cloth shall conform to type I, olive drab No. 7, class B of CCC-D-950, except that the cloth shall be made mildew-resistant by treatment limited to one of the following mildew inhibitors:

a. 2,2' Methylene - BIS (4-Chlorophenol).
b. Copper -8- Quinolinolate.

3.6 Marking.

3.6.1 Caution. The top of the end rail to the right of the elevating frame locking cam, at each end, shall be marked "CAUTION, operate release with hand underneath this rail." Marking shall be clearly visible in conspicuously colored letters at least 1/4 inch high, except for "CAUTION", which shall be 1/2 inch high. Lettering shall be permanent and legible. Marking may be made directly onto the finished surface, or by means of an attached metal plate.

3.6.2 Identification. The bed shall be marked, permanently and legibly, with the contract or purchase order number and the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer.

3.7 Service data. The contractor shall furnish, with each unit, two copies each of a technical manual which contains complete instructions for assembly, operation, maintenance, and lists of component parts. Assembly shall be fully illustrated and explained comprehensively in simple steps. The manual shall comply with the requirements of MIL-M-7298. As soon as practicable after award of the contract or purchase order, the contractor shall furnish to the Contracting Officer two preliminary copies of his proposed technical manual for review and comment by the Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center. The preliminary manuals shall be submitted sufficiently early to permit adequate review



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by the Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center (based on a maximum period of 30 days for such review) and to allow incorporation by the contractor of any required revisions and corrections in the final manual without delaying delivery under the contract or purchase order. In addition, the contractor shall furnish 15 copies of the approved technical manual to the Contracting Officer for distribution. Should the contractor have furnished acceptable manuals for the identical item within two years preceding the date of the contract and propose to furnish manuals identical to those previously accepted, then the requirements for review of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies may be waived upon request to the Contracting Officer. Waiver of submission of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies shall be at the option of the Government.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Bed shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its servicability. All burrs and sharp edges sahll be removed from the bed.

3.8.1 Welding. Welding shall be durable, sound in every detail and in accordance with the latest practices recommended by the American Welding Society. All welds shall be produced by qualified welding operators with satisfactory welding equipment using satisfactory filler metal or electrode where applicable to provide the best possible weld. Surfaces to be welded shall be free from grease, oil, oxides or any other foreign matter. Any cleaning method which will remove these substances and leave the surface clean is satisfactory. All weld joints shall blend into the adjacent metal in gradual, smooth curves. Beads shall be smooth and free of slag, excessive undercut, or excessive splatter. Sufficient metal shall be added to provide a suitable fillet or reinforcement unless otherwise specified. Welds shall not be oxidized. All welds shall be continuous with no visible voids, pin holes, or cracks.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.



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4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on the stand when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.4 and tests of 4.5.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.4 and tests of 4.5.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government, and provided also that the test methods and the results obtained comply with those described in this specification. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Inspection lot.

4.2.1 Raw materials. An inspection lot for raw material inspection shall be all material produced under the same conditions and controlled to the degree that uniformity of product within the designated lot can be assured. Lot identification of the raw material by the manufacturer is one method of control, as cited above, which is considered acceptable.

4.2.2 End product. An inspection lot for inspection of end product shall consist of all beds of the same type produced under essentially the same conditions and offered for inspection at one time.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and table I. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one bed or component, as ordered.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

| | Inspection level | AQL (defects per hundred units) |
|---|---|---|
| For visual examination | | |
| Major defects | II | 1.0 |
| Total defects (Major and Minor combined) | II | 4.0 |
| For dimensional examination | S-1 | 2.5 |



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4.3.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II, for an Inspection level of S-4 and an acceptance level of zero.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

| Component (Unit of product) | Characteristic | Requirement | Test procedure |
|---|---|---|---|
| Metal | Chemical composition | 3.2 | 4.5.1 |
| Bed | Assembly | 3.4.1 | 4.5.2 |
| | End elevation | 3.4.2 | 4.5.3 |
| | Load (elevating frame) | 3.4.3 | 4.5.4.1 |
| | Load (complete bed) | 3.4.4 | 4.5.4.2 |
| | Stability | 3.4.5 | 4.5.5 |
| | Elevating catch mechanism | 3.4.6 | 4.5.6 |
| | Enamel adhesion | 3.5 | 4.5.7 |

4.3.3 Raw materials. A sufficient quantity of each lot of each metal used in the manufacture of the beds shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.4 Examination. The bed shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table III. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed below.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Any component part missing, broken, or otherwise unusable. |
| 102 | Exposed edge not free of burrs or sharpness. |
| 103 | Components not properly assembled or aligned. |
| 104 | Canvas cover not taut (when bed is opened). |
| 105 | Bed cannot be opened and erected as required. |
| 106 | Bed ends do not elevate and hold in position as specified. |



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TABLE III. Classification of defects. - Continued

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| Minor | |
| 201 | Identification marking not complete, permanent, legible, and waterproof. |
| 202 | Finish not free of chipped areas, cracks, scratches, or roughness. |
| 203 | Any component part not securely held by mounts when not in use. |
| 204 | Style, design and construction not as shown on drawing. |
| 205 | Bed does not rest evenly on a flat surface. |

4.4.2 Dimensional examination. The bed shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerances specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.4.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit preparation, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Chemical composition. Four ounces from each lot of metal shall be tested in accordance with FED-TEST METHOD-STD No. 151.

4.5.2 Assembly. The bed shall be erected in accordance with the directions supplied. All accessory items shall be fitted into all designed locations to check for proper fit.

4.5.3 End elevation. The bed shall be fully assembled, except for the service stand and insect-bar rods. Each end shall be elevated to $10^{o}$, $20^{o}$, $30^{o}$, $40^{o}$, and the maximum setting (all measured from the horizontal). The bed ends shall be examined for slippage at each position.

4.5.4 Load bearing capability.

4.5.4.1 Elevating frame. With the bed assembled as specified in 4.5.2, both ends shall be elevated to an angle of $45^{o} \pm 2^{o}$. A uniformly distributed load of 60 pounds shall be placed along the end rail of the elevating frame.

4.5.4.2 Complete bed. With the bed assembled as specified in 4.5.2, and the ends horizontal, a uniformly distributed load of 900 pounds shall be placed on the load-bearing surface and allowed to remain for 30 minutes.



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4.5.5 Stability. With the bed surface in a horizontal position, the legs shall be blocked to prevent slippage. A plumb bob shall be fastened by a cord at the center of a transverse outer frame member. The point of the plumb bob shall be located slightly above, and centered over a 3-inch diameter circle on the floor. An individual weighing approximately 160 pounds shall lie down on the bed, roll over, move about, and sit up in the bed. The individual shall sit on the side of the bed and move along the length of the bed. The movements of the individual shall approximate, as closely as possible, those movements of a typical hospital patient. During all movements of the individual, the plumb bob shall be observed to determine whether the bob oscillates outside the 3-inch diameter circle.

4.5.6 Elevating catch mechanism. One end of the bed shall be elevated to an angle of 25 degrees. A uniformly distributed load of 40 pounds shall be placed along the end rail of the elevating frame. A spring balance shall be attached, perpendicular to the release trigger, and the pull necessary to release the cam shall be recorded.

4.5.7 Enamel adhesion. Unless otherwise specified a minimum of two items from each day's finishing shall be run through all steps of the regular finishing process, including enameling. Adhesion on the painted test specimens should generally be determined within a maximum of 72 hours drying. Press a 2 inch length of a somewhat longer piece of water-resistant, pressure sensitive adhesive tape (3/4 inch width) conforming to PPP-T-60, (transparent), firmly onto a flat or cylindrical surface of the item, rubbing out all air bubbles under the tape. Allow approximately 10 seconds for the test area to return to room temperature. Grasp a free end of the tape and at a rapid speed strip it from the item by pulling the tape back upon itself at 180 degress (in such a manner that the tape is folded back to back during the procedure). Observe for bared areas where the enamel is removed. Disregard flecks of enamel on tape where the underlying metal or phosphate coating is not visibly exposed. If any test specimen indicates failure all items processed since last acceptance shall be rejected and corrective action taken.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit preparation. Each bed along with components shall be clean and dry. The I.V. and insect-bar rods, elevating arcs, bed side tray, vinyl foam pad, pad cover and the patient's effects bag shall be neatly folded and individually wrapped in kraft paper or other suitable material. The legs shall be detached from their sockets on the bed frame but not removed from the support cables, and



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wrapped in kraft paper or other suitable material. All wrapping shall be secured with pressure sensitive or kraft gummed tape. The bed frame with the canvas elevating cover in place shall be folded. The wrapped components shall be neatly inserted between the folded halves of the bed frame. The frame shall be secured in the folded position by buckling of the two end straps. The completely folded and secured bed shall be wrapped in kraft paper and secured with pressure sensitive or kraft gummed tape.

5.1.2 Level C. Each bed along with components shall be clean, dry, neatly folded, and packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Each bed packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level C. Each packaged bed shall be packed in a shipping container in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior wraps. Interior wraps shall be marked to identify contents and quantity.

5.3.2 Shipping container. Shipping containers shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The bed is intended for use in field or fixed military medical facilities and is a component of the Medical Unit, Self Contained, Transportable.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).



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6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested and approved under the appropriate provisions of the Defense Acquisition Regulation/ Armed Services Procurement Regulation. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

| National Stock Number | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6530-01-015-5189 | BED, ADJUSTABLE, Hospital, Folding, Field. |

6.5 The bed components listed in 3.3 are stock listed as follows:

| National Stock Number | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 7210-00-118-0008 | COVER, BED FRAME, Cotton Duck 26-3/4 by 77-5/8 inches. |
| 7210-00-118-0009 | PAD, MATTRESS, Hospital Bed, Vinyl Foam, 27-1/2 by 76-1/2 inches. |
| 7210-00-118-0010 | COVER, MATTRESS PAD, Cotton Duck, 28 by 77 inches. |
| 8465-00-115-6029 | BAG, PERSONAL EFFECTS, Olive-Drab, Cotton. |
| 6530-00-115-6028 | STAND, BED SERVICE, Aluminum, 24 by 11-5/8 by 11-5/8 inches. |
| 7210-00-118-0011 | ROD, INSECT BAR, Aluminum. |

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DoD - MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6530-1377

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MIL-B-36558A BED, ADJUSTABLE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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